

THE SHREDDER PROTOCOL

Advanced Steam Cloud Manual Synchronization & Recovery

Lead Architect: Shredder (The Mechanic) / D1

Status: Finalized | **Target Engine:** Universal Steam Logic

Contextual Note: This protocol utilizes **Forza Horizon 5** and **Xbox Identity** as the operational baseline. However, the logic is modular. Substitute the **AppID** to apply this recovery to any Steam title.

Phase 1: Intel Gathering (The AppID)

Every Steam application is indexed by a unique numerical identifier. To repair a specific game, identify its ID via SteamDB.

- **Forza Horizon 5 Example:** 1551360
- **Local Root:** C:\Program Files (x86)\Steam\userdata\[YourID]\[AppID]\

Phase 2: Forge Initialization (Environment Setup)

Modern OS installs often fail to initialize background Python variables correctly. These steps are mandatory.

1. **Install Python:** `winget install Python.Python.3.12`
2. **Disable Aliases:** Settings > Apps > Advanced app settings > App execution aliases.
Turn OFF `python.exe` and `python3.exe`.
3. **Dependencies:** `python -m pip install requests beautifulsoup4`

Phase 3: The Handshake Key (Cookie Extraction)

The Steam Cloud is protected by session-based authentication. You must extract your browser's session token to allow the script to impersonate your account.

Method A: The Console Command (Fastest)

Navigate to the Steam Cloud portal, press **F12**, select **Console**, and execute:

```
copy(document.cookie).
```

Method B: The Network Header (Manual)

In Developer Tools (F12), go to the **Network** tab. Refresh the page. Click the **remotestorageapp** request. In **Request Headers**, copy the entire value of the **Cookie** field.

Phase 4: The Recovery Script (Extraction)

```
import os, requests, time
from bs4 import BeautifulSoup

# --- CONFIGURATION ---
COOKIE_STRING = "PASTE_YOUR_COOKIE_HERE"
APP_ID = "1551360"
# -----

DOWNLOAD_BASE = "Cloud_Recovery_Output"
headers = {"User-Agent": "Mozilla/5.0", "Cookie": COOKIE_STRING}

def run_protocol():
    if not os.path.exists(DOWNLOAD_BASE): os.makedirs(DOWNLOAD_BASE)
    session = requests.Session()
    session.headers.update(headers)
    index, total = 0, 0

    while True:
        url = f"https://store.steampowered.com/account/remotestorageapp/?appid={APP_ID}&index={index}"
        resp = session.get(url)
        if resp.status_code != 200: break

        soup = BeautifulSoup(resp.text, 'html.parser')
        rows = soup.find_all('tr')[1:]
        if not rows: break

        page_hits = 0
        for row in rows:
            cols = row.find_all('td')
            if len(cols) < 4: continue

            rel_path = cols[1].text.strip()
            link = row.find('a', href=True)
            if not link or 'download' not in link['href'].lower(): continue

            out_path = os.path.join(DOWNLOAD_BASE, rel_path)
            if os.path.exists(out_path):
                total += 1; continue
```

```
os.makedirs(os.path.dirname(out_path), exist_ok=True)
f_data = session.get(link['href']).content
with open(out_path, 'wb') as f:
    f.write(f_data)

page_hits += 1; total += 1
if total % 10 == 0: print(f"[*] Secured {total} files...")

if page_hits == 0: break
index += 50; time.sleep(0.5)

print(f"\n[+] SUCCESS: {total} files secured.")

if __name__ == "__main__":
    run_protocol()
```

Phase 5: Surgical Injection (Local Override)

1. **Terminate Steam:** Kill `steam.exe` in Task Manager.
2. **Wipe Metadata:** Go to the AppID folder in your userdata. Delete the `remote` folder and `remotecache.vdf`.
3. **Inject:** Create a new `remote` folder. Copy all contents from the script's output into it. Preserve all nested XUID folders.

Phase 6: Final Verification Cycle

Launch Steam. Select "**Upload Local Files to Steam Cloud.**" Launch the game and ensure the **Xbox App** is logged in. Allow the in-game sync to complete (this may take 15+ minutes). Trigger an autosave in-game to lock the new state.